

Alexander McCobin

Founder & CEO, Liberty Ventures Network · Principled Business Summit · May 2026

WHO HE IS

Alexander McCobin is the Founder and CEO of Liberty Ventures Network — a platform spanning investor networks, executive membership, events, and a media property (Capitalists for Capitalism). His flagship event is the **Principled Business Summit**, an invitation-only gathering of business leaders committed to advancing capitalism as a force for good. Past summits have been held at venues like Richard Branson's Necker Island (50-person format, curated by Host Committee). The Austin summit is the next installment — and he wants it to be the largest gathering of principled business leaders ever.

He runs multiple parallel channels under LVN: investing arm, Executive Circle membership, events calendar, and the Principled Business brand. Michelle Bernier is his Chief of Staff and the operational hub for all summit logistics.

HOW THIS CAME TOGETHER

March 2026: Alexander nominated you for the Necker Island Principled Business Summit (May 12–16, 50 attendees, Kelsey Grammer keynote). You declined due to prior commitments — but pointed him to Scott McMichael for the Atlanta Executive Summit. The relationship held.

May 1, 2026: Curtis (mutual) flagged the Austin summit. You reached out cold — low-pressure, no ask, purely offering to speak on AI for executive audiences. You explicitly told him the friendship wasn't on the line.

May 2, 2026: Alexander replied immediately: *"I would LOVE to have you join... and speak about AI. And talk about ways to work together in building this conference up to be the largest gathering ever of principled business leaders."* He looped in Michelle and asked about your availability. That's a fast yes — and he added a second agenda item beyond just the speaking slot.

TWO THINGS ON THE TABLE

Alexander's reply signals two distinct asks — don't conflate them:

- **Speaking slot: AI for principled business leaders.** He wants you on stage. This is straightforward — he's been watching you work, he knows your angle, and executive AI literacy is exactly the kind of forward-looking content his audience pays attention to.
- **Partnership to grow the summit.** "Ways to work together in building this conference" is a second conversation — broader, more commercial. Could mean sponsorship, co-promotion through Improving's network, bringing in clients/prospects as attendees, or some kind of formal affiliation. He's thinking bigger than a single talk.

Come in ready to separate these cleanly. Confirm the speaker role first — that's the easy yes. Then explore the partnership piece as a distinct conversation with more structure.

CONVERSATION THREADS

- **What's the Austin summit format and timing?** You don't have the date, size, or structure yet. Get specifics — who attends, how many, venue, agenda flow.
- **What does he want from the AI talk?** Inspiration vs. practical framework? CEO-level or operator-level? What's the audience already doing with AI, and what misconceptions does he want addressed?
- **How does he envision Improving fitting into the LVN ecosystem?** Is the partnership play sponsorship, referrals, co-hosting, or something else? What would success look like to him in 12 months?

- **The Atlanta Executive Summit.** Scott McMichael was supposed to attend. Ask how that went and whether Scott made it — acknowledges the relationship continuity and gives you a pulse on LVN's broader engagement with Improving.
 - **Curtis connection.** Curtis tipped you off — worth acknowledging and asking how Alexander knows Curtis. That thread may reveal more mutual network.
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WHAT TO WATCH FOR

- **He's a builder, not a buyer.** He's not here to procure technology services — he's trying to grow a movement. The value exchange has to feel like mission alignment, not sponsorship activation.
 - **"Largest gathering ever" is the tell.** That phrase means he's thinking about scale, not just the next event. If Improving can help him get there — through brand, network, or resources — that's the real conversation.
 - **Fast reply cadence = high priority.** He responded same-day and looped in his CoS immediately. He's not doing you a favor — he genuinely wants this to happen. Don't undersell.
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ONE ASK

Walk out with: (1) a confirmed speaker slot with a topic brief, and (2) a follow-up call or email scheduled with Michelle to scope the partnership angle. Don't let the partnership conversation collapse into vague goodwill — it needs a next step with a timeline.
